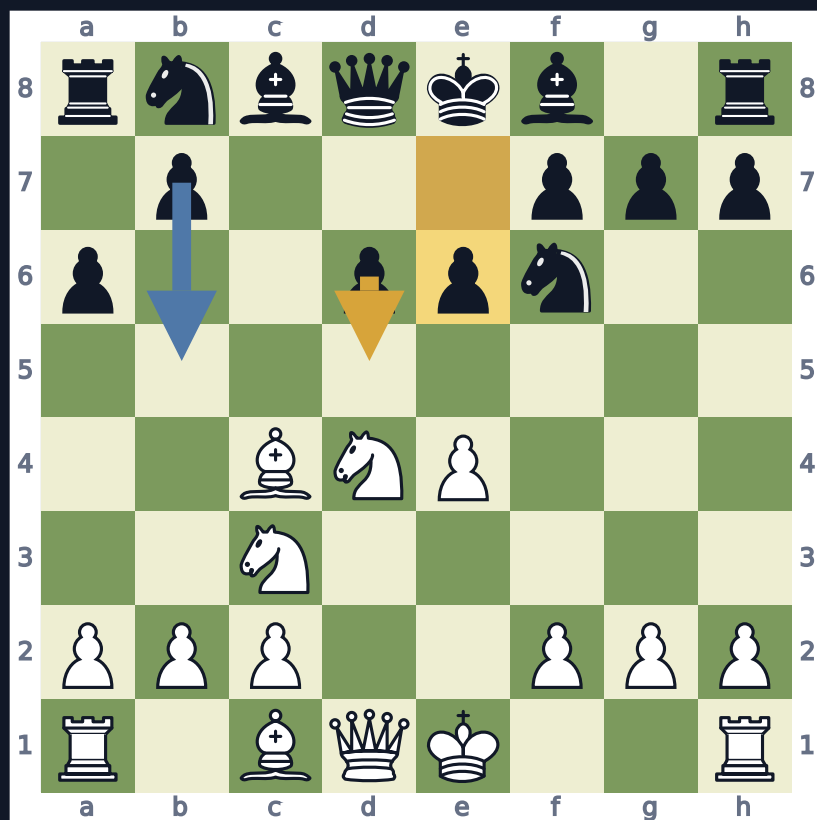


08

6.Bc4 and Sozin Attacks

Pressure on f7, the e6 target, and the exact moment Black can strike in the center.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will distinguish a real sacrifice on e6 or f7 from a decorative bishop and meet the attack with development and central counterplay.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 043 | PAGE 4

Decode: The bishop points at f7*Before expanding, calculate the sacrifice on the base of the center.*

LESSON 044 | PAGE 8

Play: The bishop points at f7*Before expanding, calculate the sacrifice on the base of the center.*

LESSON 045 | PAGE 12

Decode: Sozin queenside expansion*The queenside gain is justified only if it helps answer the central hit.*

LESSON 046 | PAGE 16

Play: Sozin queenside expansion*The queenside gain is justified only if it helps answer the central hit.*

LESSON 047 | PAGE 20

Decode: Sozin with controlled castling*King safety converts scary-looking sacrifices into calculable lines.*

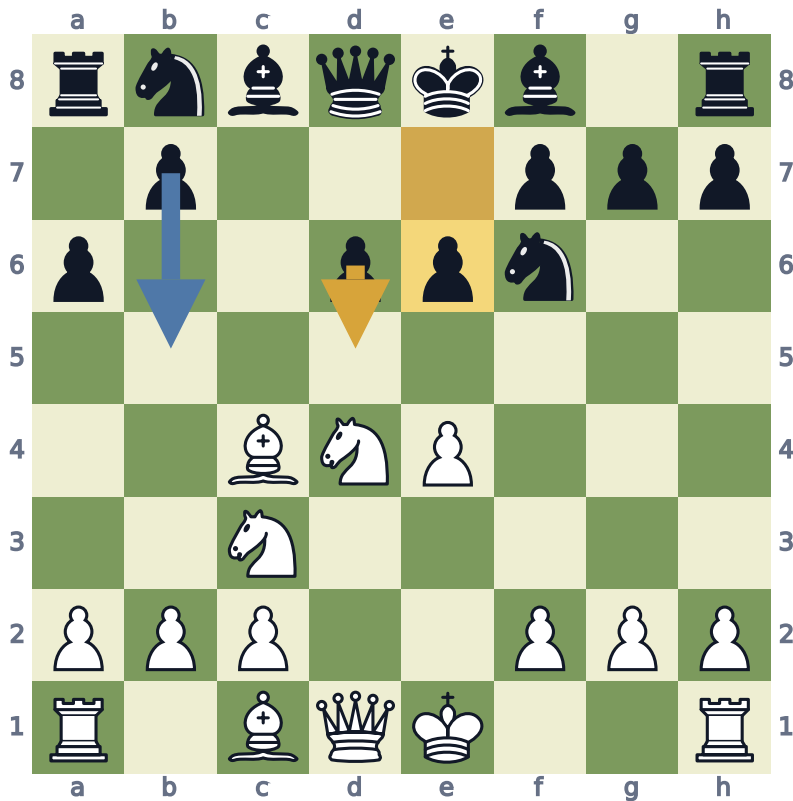
LESSON 048 | PAGE 24

Play: Sozin with controlled castling*King safety converts scary-looking sacrifices into calculable lines.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will distinguish a real sacrifice on e6 or f7 from a decorative bishop and meet the attack with development and central counterplay.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The bishop points at f7

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

Bc4 creates tactical motifs on e6 and f7, but the bishop can lose time when ...b5 attacks it.

DECISION RULE

What happens after Bxe6 or Nxe6 in every candidate position?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Build ...e6, develop, and use ...b5 with tempo only when e6 cannot be tactically destroyed.

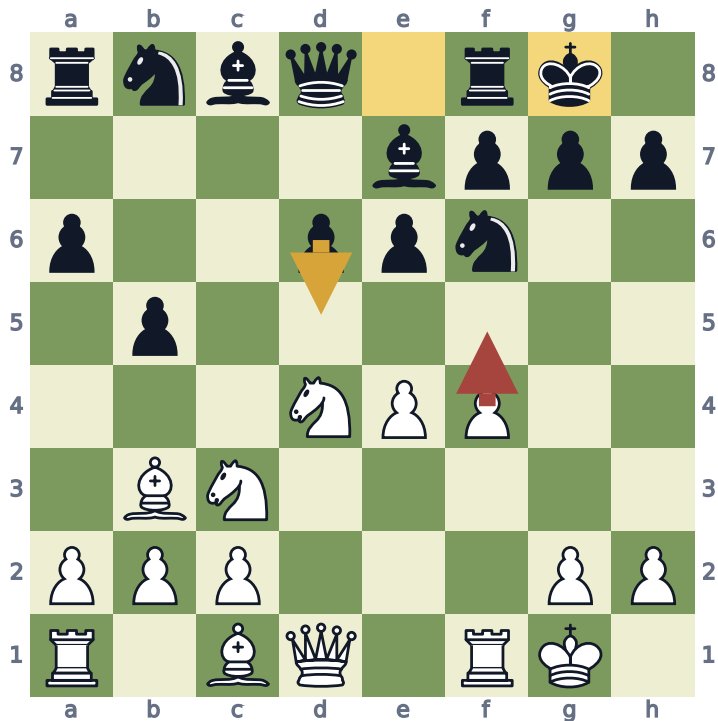
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses f4-f5, e5, and sacrifices on e6 to open the king before Black consolidates.

MEMORY RULE | Before expanding, calculate the sacrifice on the base of the center.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Bc4 creates tactical motifs on e6 and f7, but the bishop can lose time when ...b5 attacks it.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Build ...e6, develop, and use ...b5 with tempo only when e6 cannot be tactically destroyed.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White uses f4-f5, e5, and sacrifices on e6 to open the king before Black consolidates.

FAILURE MODE

Winning a bishop tempo with ...b5 while the e6 pawn is tactically undefended.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What happens after Bxe6 or Nxe6 in every candidate position? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

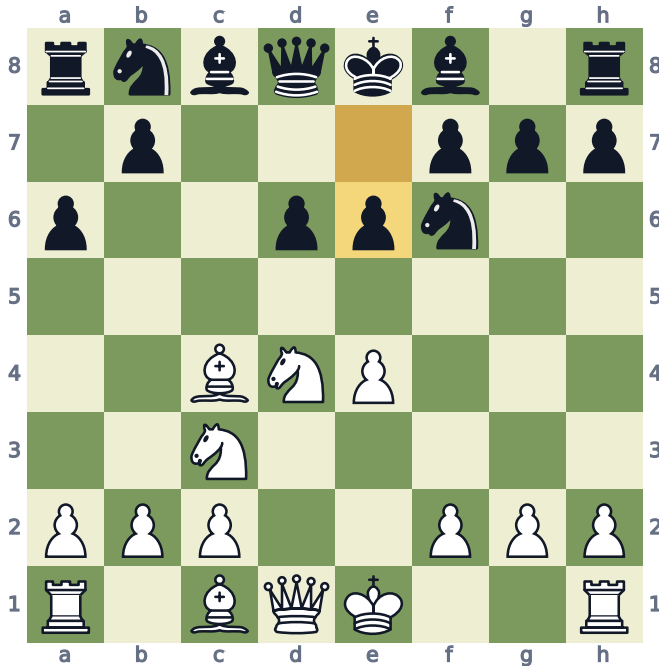
RULE | Before expanding, calculate the sacrifice on the base of the center.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bc4 e6 7. Bb3 b5 8. O-O Be7 9. f4 O-O



- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Bc4: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Bc4 creates tactical motifs on e6 and f7, but the bishop can lose time when ...b5 attacks it.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What happens after Bxe6 or Nxe6 in every candidate position? White's resistance is: White uses f4-f5, e5, and sacrifices on e6 to open the king before Black consolidates. The line fails as a template when: Winning a bishop tempo with ...b5 while the e6 pawn is tactically undefended.

STORE THIS | Before expanding, calculate the sacrifice on the base of the center.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

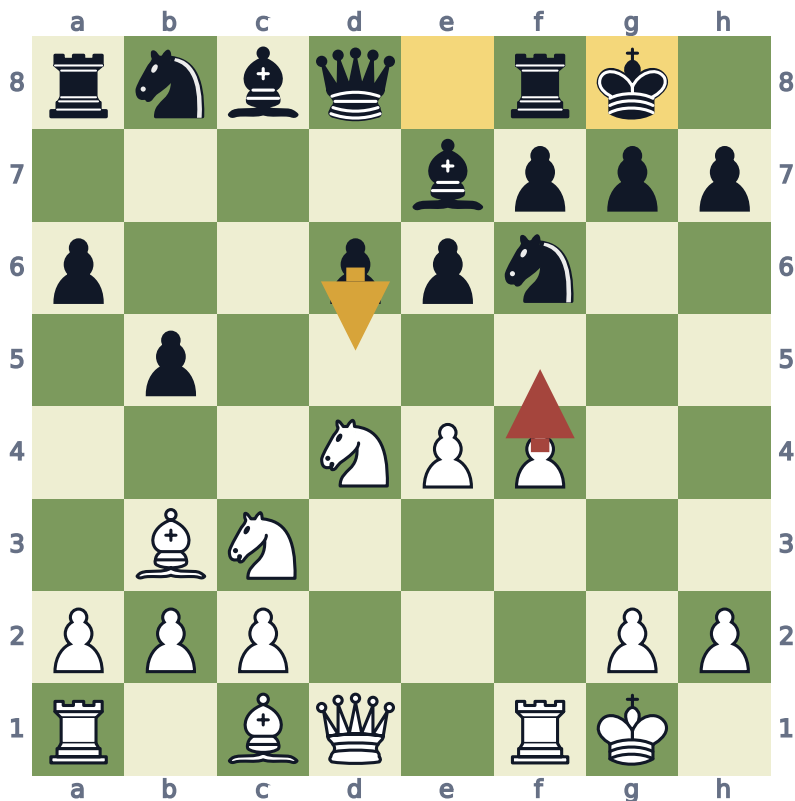
1. Bc4 creates tactical motifs on e6 and f7, but the bishop can lose time when ...b5 attacks it. 2. Build ...e6, develop, and use ...b5 with tempo only when e6 cannot be tactically destroyed. 3. White uses f4-f5, e5, and sacrifices on e6 to open the king before Black consolidates. 4. What happens after Bxe6 or Nxe6 in every candidate position? 5. Winning a bishop tempo with ...b5 while the e6 pawn is tactically undefended.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bc4 e6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The bishop points at f7



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Bc4 creates tactical motifs on e6 and f7, but the bishop can lose time when ...b5 attacks it.

DECISION RULE

What happens after Bxe6 or Nxe6 in every candidate position?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Build ...e6, develop, and use ...b5 with tempo only when e6 cannot be tactically destroyed.

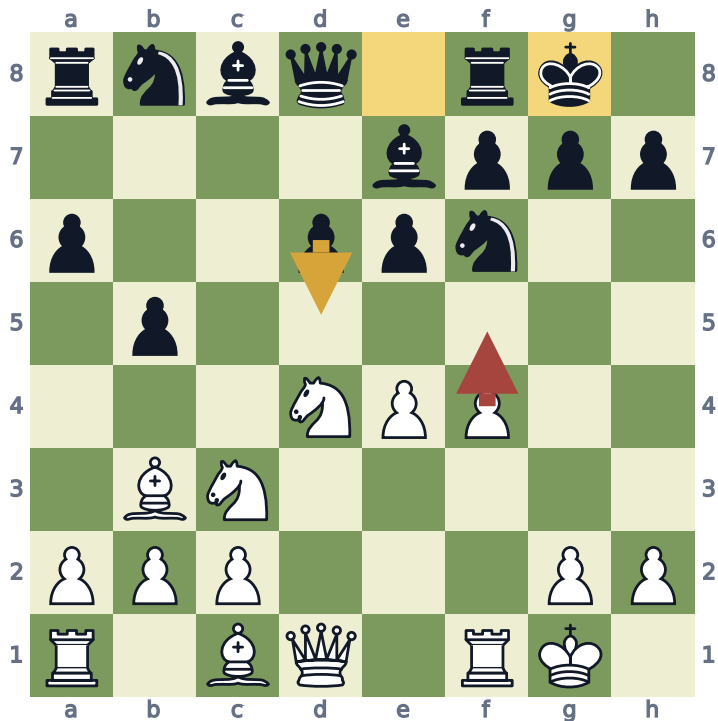
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses f4-f5, e5, and sacrifices on e6 to open the king before Black consolidates.

MEMORY RULE | Before expanding, calculate the sacrifice on the base of the center.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Bc4 creates tactical motifs on e6 and f7, but the bishop can lose time when ...b5 attacks it.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Build ...e6, develop, and use ...b5 with tempo only when e6 cannot be tactically destroyed.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White uses f4-f5, e5, and sacrifices on e6 to open the king before Black consolidates.

FAILURE MODE

Winning a bishop tempo with ...b5 while the e6 pawn is tactically undefended.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What happens after Bxe6 or Nxe6 in every candidate position? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

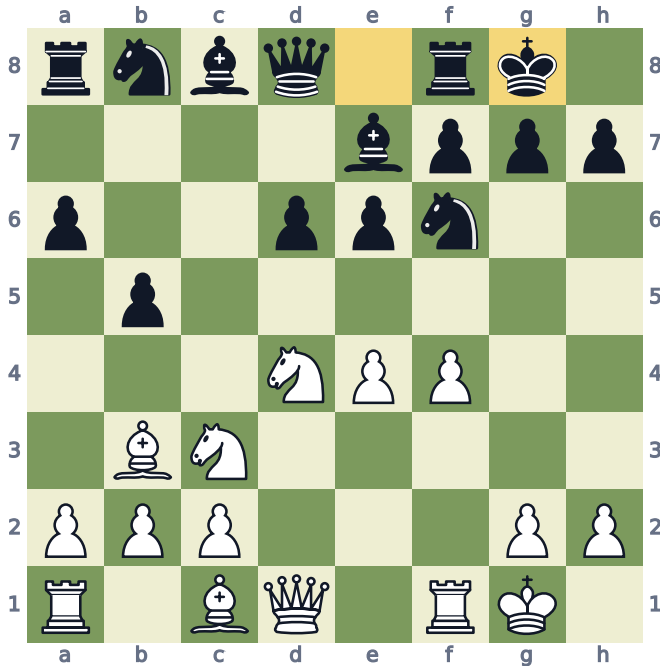
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bc4 e6 7. Bb3 b5 8. O-O Be7 9. f4 O-O



- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- b5: Black starts queenside expansion and prepares files or a bishop diagonal.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- f4: White claims kingside space and announces e5 or f5 attacking ideas.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Bc4 creates tactical motifs on e6 and f7, but the bishop can lose time when ...b5 attacks it.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What happens after Bxe6 or Nxe6 in every candidate position? White's resistance is: White uses f4-f5, e5, and sacrifices on e6 to open the king before Black consolidates. The line fails as a template when: Winning a bishop tempo with ...b5 while the e6 pawn is tactically undefended.

STORE THIS | Before expanding, calculate the sacrifice on the base of the center.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

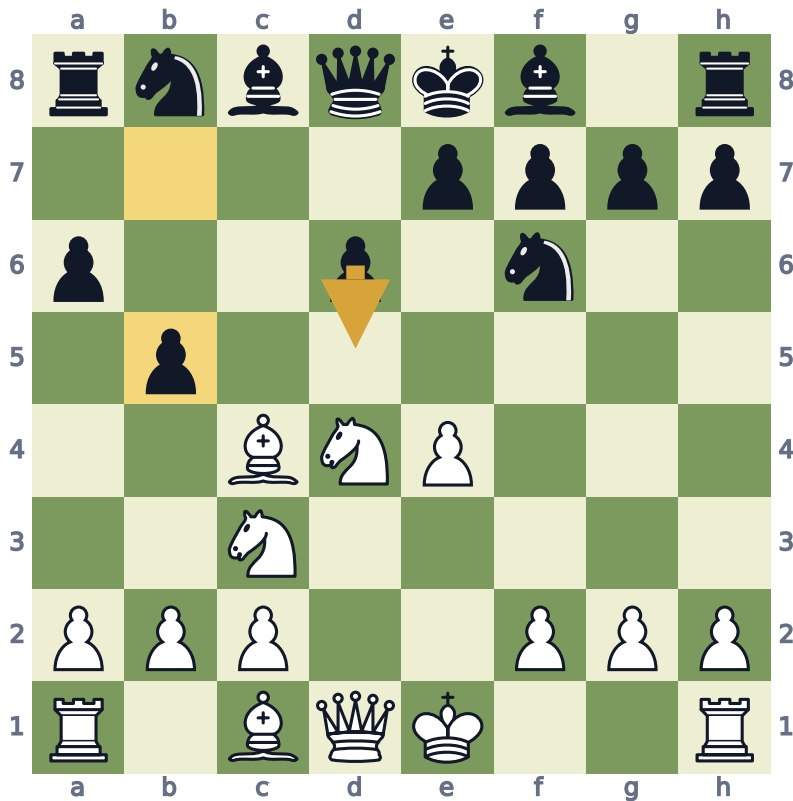
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. Bb3 b5 8. O-O Be7 9. f4 O-O

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Sozin queenside expansion



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Immediate ...b5 gains space and develops the bishop to b7, but Black must survive pressure on e6 and the long diagonal.

DECISION RULE

Does ...b5 create a useful bishop and tempo before White's e5 break lands?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Finish development rapidly and make the b7 bishop relevant through central contact.

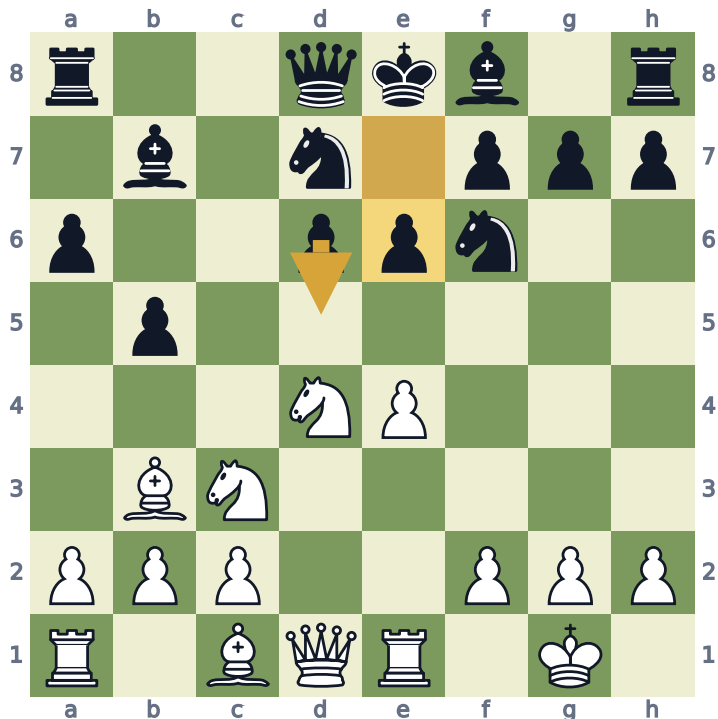
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White centralizes with Re1 and prepares e5, turning Black's queenside tempi into a test of the center.

MEMORY RULE | The queenside gain is justified only if it helps answer the central hit.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Immediate ...b5 gains space and develops the bishop to b7, but Black must survive pressure on e6 and the long diagonal.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Finish development rapidly and make the b7 bishop relevant through central contact.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White centralizes with Re1 and prepares e5, turning Black's queenside tempi into a test of the center.

FAILURE MODE

Expanding farther with ...b4 while the king and central pawns remain vulnerable.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Does ...b5 create a useful bishop and tempo before White's e5 break lands? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

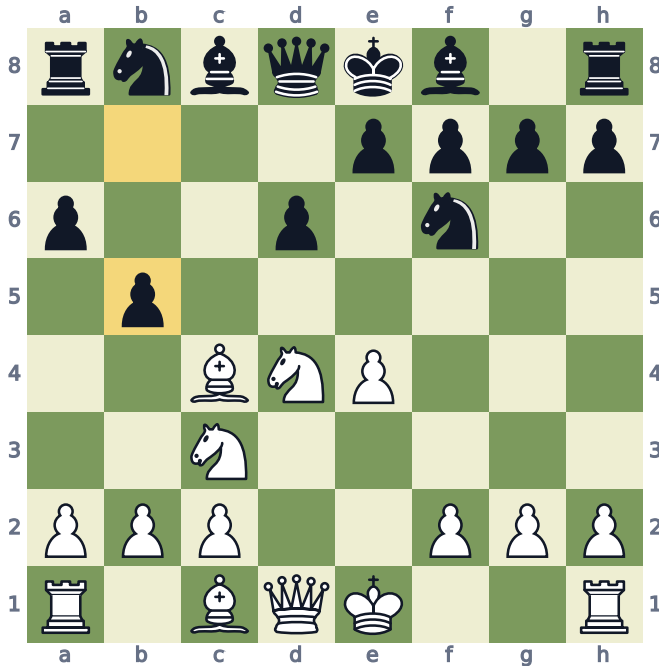
RULE | The queenside gain is justified only if it helps answer the central hit.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bc4 b5 7. Bb3 Bb7 8. O-O Nbd7 9. Re1 e6



- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Bc4: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- b5: Black starts queenside expansion and prepares files or a bishop diagonal.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Immediate ...b5 gains space and develops the bishop to b7, but Black must survive pressure on e6 and the long diagonal.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Does ...b5 create a useful bishop and tempo before White's e5 break lands? White's resistance is: White centralizes with Re1 and prepares e5, turning Black's queenside tempi into a test of the center. The line fails as a template when: Expanding farther with ...b4 while the king and central pawns remain vulnerable.

STORE THIS | The queenside gain is justified only if it helps answer the central hit.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

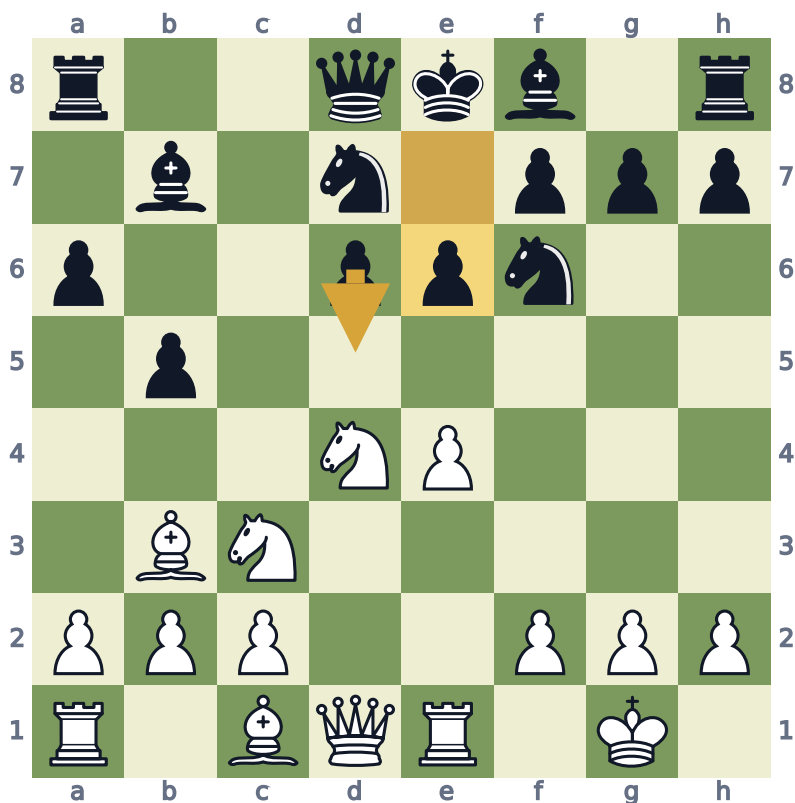
1. Immediate ...b5 gains space and develops the bishop to b7, but Black must survive pressure on e6 and the long diagonal. 2. Finish development rapidly and make the b7 bishop relevant through central contact. 3. White centralizes with Re1 and prepares e5, turning Black's queenside tempi into a test of the center. 4. Does ...b5 create a useful bishop and tempo before White's e5 break lands? 5. Expanding farther with ...b4 while the king and central pawns remain vulnerable.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bc4 b5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Sozin queenside expansion



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Immediate ...b5 gains space and develops the bishop to b7, but Black must survive pressure on e6 and the long diagonal.

DECISION RULE

Does ...b5 create a useful bishop and tempo before White's e5 break lands?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Finish development rapidly and make the b7 bishop relevant through central contact.

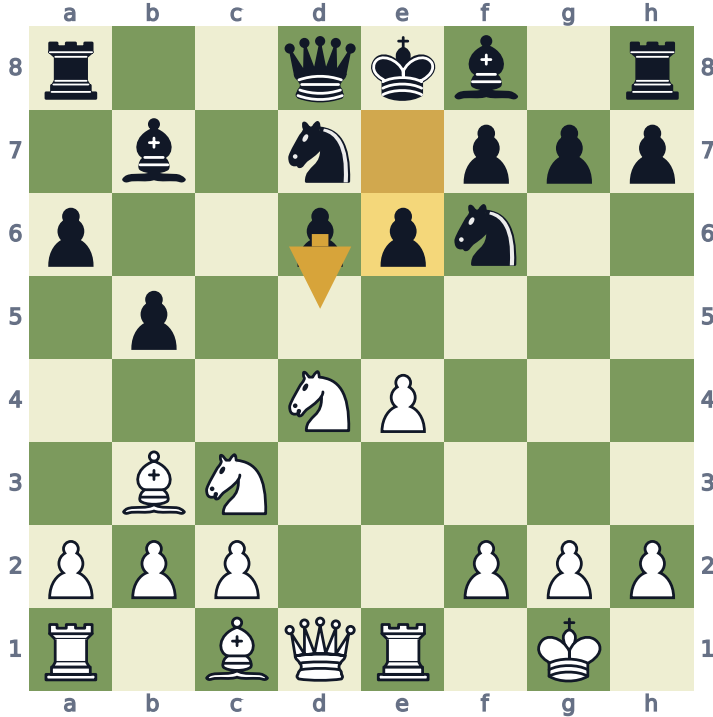
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White centralizes with Re1 and prepares e5, turning Black's queenside tempi into a test of the center.

MEMORY RULE | The queenside gain is justified only if it helps answer the central hit.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Immediate ...b5 gains space and develops the bishop to b7, but Black must survive pressure on e6 and the long diagonal.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Finish development rapidly and make the b7 bishop relevant through central contact.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White centralizes with Re1 and prepares e5, turning Black's queenside tempi into a test of the center.

FAILURE MODE

Expanding farther with ...b4 while the king and central pawns remain vulnerable.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Does ...b5 create a useful bishop and tempo before White's e5 break lands? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

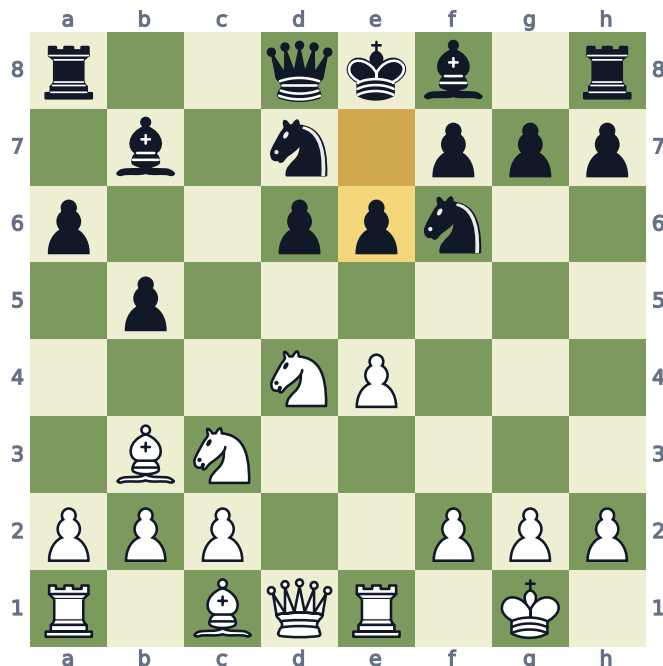
RULE | The queenside gain is justified only if it helps answer the central hit.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bc4 b5 7. Bb3 Bb7 8. O-O Nbd7 9. Re1 e6



- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Immediate ...b5 gains space and develops the bishop to b7, but Black must survive pressure on e6 and the long diagonal.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Does ...b5 create a useful bishop and tempo before White's e5 break lands? White's resistance is: White centralizes with Re1 and prepares e5, turning Black's queenside tempi into a test of the center. The line fails as a template when: Expanding farther with ...b4 while the king and central pawns remain vulnerable.

STORE THIS | The queenside gain is justified only if it helps answer the central hit.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

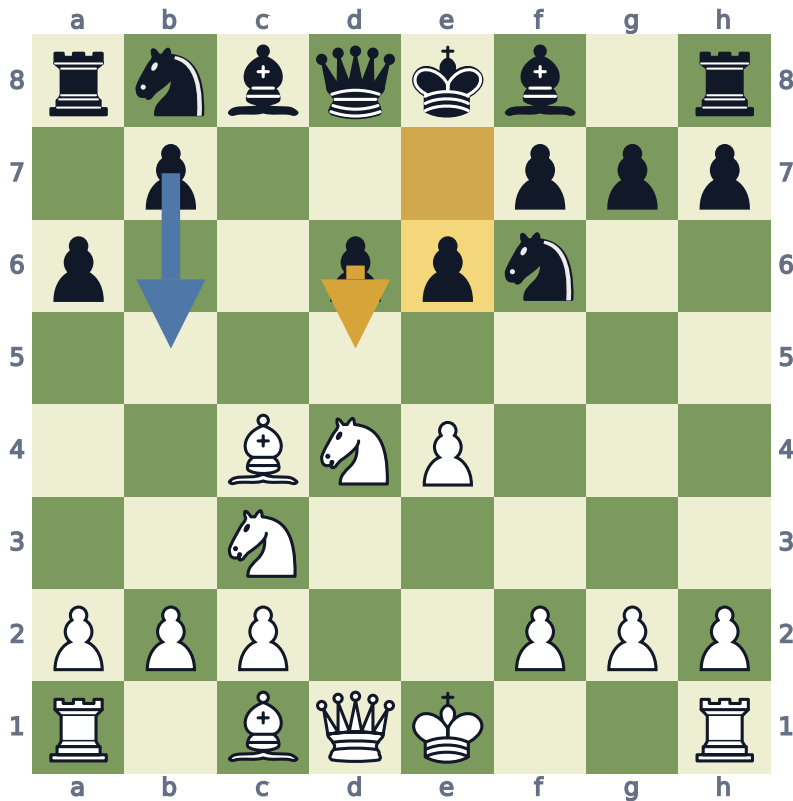
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. Bb3 Bb7 8. O-O Nbd7 9. Re1 e6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Sozin with controlled castling

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

Early castling removes many sacrificial checks and lets Black meet the attack with coordinated pieces.

DECISION RULE

Which white break is actually ready, and what forcing reply meets it?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Secure the king, connect rooks, and challenge White's center before the f-pawn advance becomes a direct attack.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White gains space with f4 and seeks e5 or f5 while the bishop keeps f7 under observation.

MEMORY RULE | King safety converts scary-looking sacrifices into calculable lines.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Early castling removes many sacrificial checks and lets Black meet the attack with coordinated pieces.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Secure the king, connect rooks, and challenge White's center before the f-pawn advance becomes a direct attack.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White gains space with f4 and seeks e5 or f5 while the bishop keeps f7 under observation.

FAILURE MODE

Playing a routine developing move when White has already prepared e5 with tempo.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which white break is actually ready, and what forcing reply meets it? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

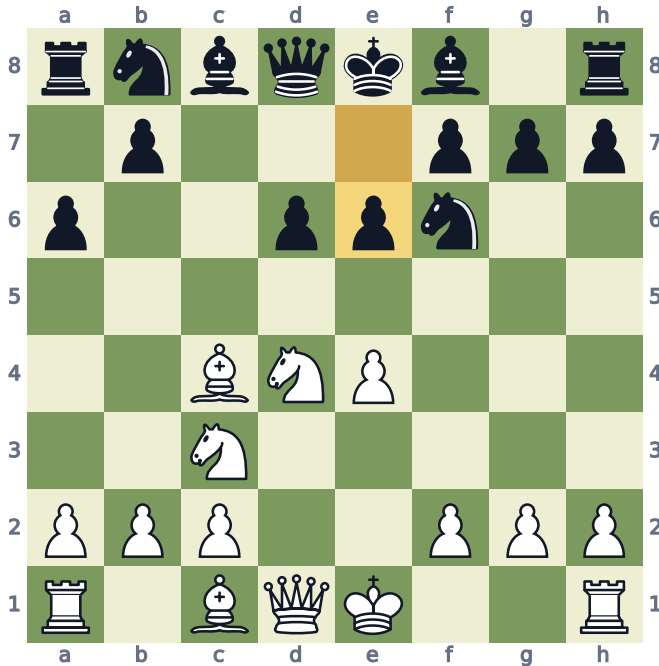
RULE | King safety converts scary-looking sacrifices into calculable lines.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bc4 e6 7. O-O Be7 8. Bb3 O-O 9. f4 Qc7



- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Bc4: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Early castling removes many sacrificial checks and lets Black meet the attack with coordinated pieces.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which white break is actually ready, and what forcing reply meets it? White's resistance is: White gains space with f4 and seeks e5 or f5 while the bishop keeps f7 under observation. The line fails as a template when: Playing a routine developing move when White has already prepared e5 with tempo.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Early castling removes many sacrificial checks and lets Black meet the attack with coordinated pieces. 2. Secure the king, connect rooks, and challenge White's center before the f-pawn advance becomes a direct attack. 3. White gains space with f4 and seeks e5 or f5 while the bishop keeps f7 under observation. 4. Which white break is actually ready, and what forcing reply meets it? 5. Playing a routine developing move when White has already prepared e5 with tempo.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bc4 e6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Sozin with controlled castling



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Early castling removes many sacrificial checks and lets Black meet the attack with coordinated pieces.

DECISION RULE

Which white break is actually ready, and what forcing reply meets it?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Secure the king, connect rooks, and challenge White's center before the f-pawn advance becomes a direct attack.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White gains space with f4 and seeks e5 or f5 while the bishop keeps f7 under observation.

MEMORY RULE | King safety converts scary-looking sacrifices into calculable lines.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Early castling removes many sacrificial checks and lets Black meet the attack with coordinated pieces.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Secure the king, connect rooks, and challenge White's center before the f-pawn advance becomes a direct attack.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White gains space with f4 and seeks e5 or f5 while the bishop keeps f7 under observation.

FAILURE MODE

Playing a routine developing move when White has already prepared e5 with tempo.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which white break is actually ready, and what forcing reply meets it? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

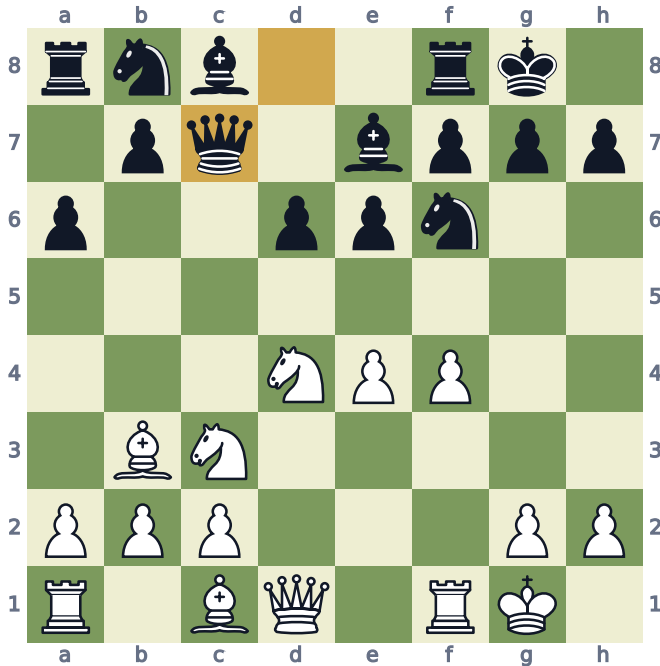
RULE | King safety converts scary-looking sacrifices into calculable lines.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bc4 e6 7. O-O Be7 8. Bb3 O-O 9. f4 Qc7



- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- f4: White claims kingside space and announces e5 or f5 attacking ideas.
- Qc7: Black coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Early castling removes many sacrificial checks and lets Black meet the attack with coordinated pieces.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which white break is actually ready, and what forcing reply meets it? White's resistance is: White gains space with f4 and seeks e5 or f5 while the bishop keeps f7 under observation. The line fails as a template when: Playing a routine developing move when White has already prepared e5 with tempo.

STORE THIS | King safety converts scary-looking sacrifices into calculable lines.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Early castling removes many sacrificial checks and lets Black meet the attack with coordinated pieces. 2. Secure the king, connect rooks, and challenge White's center before the f-pawn advance becomes a direct attack. 3. White gains space with f4 and seeks e5 or f5 while the bishop keeps f7 under observation. 4. Which white break is actually ready, and what forcing reply meets it? 5. Playing a routine developing move when White has already prepared e5 with tempo.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. O-O Be7 8. Bb3 O-O 9. f4 Qc7

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 043 Decode: The bishop points at f7

Prompt: What happens after Bxe6 or Nxe6 in every candidate position?

Recall: Before expanding, calculate the sacrifice on the base of the center.

LESSON 044 Play: The bishop points at f7

Prompt: What happens after Bxe6 or Nxe6 in every candidate position?

Recall: Before expanding, calculate the sacrifice on the base of the center.

LESSON 045 Decode: Sozin queenside expansion

Prompt: Does ...b5 create a useful bishop and tempo before White's e5 break lands?

Recall: The queenside gain is justified only if it helps answer the central hit.

LESSON 046 Play: Sozin queenside expansion

Prompt: Does ...b5 create a useful bishop and tempo before White's e5 break lands?

Recall: The queenside gain is justified only if it helps answer the central hit.

LESSON 047 Decode: Sozin with controlled castling

Prompt: Which white break is actually ready, and what forcing reply meets it?

Recall: King safety converts scary-looking sacrifices into calculable lines.

LESSON 048 Play: Sozin with controlled castling

Prompt: Which white break is actually ready, and what forcing reply meets it?

Recall: King safety converts scary-looking sacrifices into calculable lines.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The bishop points at f7

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bc4 e6 7. Bb3 b5 8. O-O Be7 9. f4 O-O

Decision: What happens after Bxe6 or Nxe6 in every candidate position?

Memory: Before expanding, calculate the sacrifice on the base of the center.

CARD 2

Sozin queenside expansion

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bc4 b5 7. Bb3 Bb7 8. O-O Nbd7 9. Re1 e6

Decision: Does ...b5 create a useful bishop and tempo before White's e5 break lands?

Memory: The queenside gain is justified only if it helps answer the central hit.

CARD 3

Sozin with controlled castling

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bc4 e6 7. O-O Be7 8. Bb3 O-O 9. f4 Qc7

Decision: Which white break is actually ready, and what forcing reply meets it?

Memory: King safety converts scary-looking sacrifices into calculable lines.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
043 Decode: The bishop points at f7	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
044 Play: The bishop points at f7	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
045 Decode: Sozin queenside expansion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
046 Play: Sozin queenside expansion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
047 Decode: Sozin with controlled castling	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
048 Play: Sozin with controlled castling	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.